

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- ASCL told Tes its 'scope for negotiation is exhausted' on Ofsted's impact on leader wellbeing; its council met this week to weigh 'more assertive action', and Lucy Powell has written back admitting the system is 'high-stakes and low-trust'.
→ **For your school:** *Nothing to action yet, but worth watching closely.*
- NASUWT is demanding the government republish its funding table for the 3.5% teacher pay rise, arguing schools are being left to cover part of it despite ministers' pension-saving claims.
→ **For your school:** *Stress-test this term's budget against the funding assumptions NASUWT is disputing.*
- High Storrs became Sheffield's top-rated secondary under Ofsted's new framework, with a 'strong standard' rating across every inspected area.
- Sheffield City Council joined a near-90-council scheme to tackle NEET numbers among 16-17 year-olds, days after the city was flagged as having one of England's higher rates.
→ **For your school:** *Useful context for careers leads ahead of post-16 destinations conversations.*

DATES FOR THE DIARY

- 16 Oct 2026** — Sheffield's Year 7 secondary school application deadline for September 2027 entry closes.
- 16 Oct 2026** — Teachers' 2026 pay determination document expected to be laid before Parliament (LGA-estimated date).
- 28 Oct 2026** — Final deadline for academies and local authorities to submit autumn school census returns.
- 6 Nov 2026** — Deadline for schools and colleges to request changes to their 2027-28 high needs place numbers.

■ OFSTED & ACCOUNTABILITY: ASCL WARNS 'SCOPE FOR NEGOTIATION IS EXHAUSTED'

- **ASCL's council met this week to decide on 'more assertive action' over Ofsted's impact on leader wellbeing.** General secretary Pepe Di'lasio said negotiation had been exhausted; Powell responded in writing that the current system is 'high-stakes and low-trust' and that she wants one that is 'more supportive'. ([Tes](#))

→ **For your school:** *Worth watching — a union escalation could pull any framework change forward.*

■ FUNDING: A PAY-FUNDING ROW, AND A HIGH-NEEDS DEADLINE TO NOTE

- **NASUWT says the 3.5% teacher pay rise isn't funded the way ministers claim.** The union argues pension-scheme savings cited by Powell were already built into school budgets, so schools may have to find the money themselves; it wants the original funding table republished. ([Personnel Today](#))
→ **For your school:** *Check this term's budget against the funding assumptions NASUWT is disputing.*

- **Schools and colleges must request any 2027-28 high needs place changes by 6 November.** This week's DfE Update confirms that if no request is made, 2026-27 place numbers simply roll over and set next year's funding allocation. ([GOV.UK \(DfE Update academies, 7 October 2026\)](#))
→ **For your school:** Confirm with your SENCo and finance lead whether specialist place numbers need updating.

■ SHEFFIELD: A TOP OFSTED RATING AND A NEW NEET ACTION PLAN

- **High Storrs is now Sheffield's best-rated secondary under Ofsted's stricter framework.** The Bents Green school, run by Minerva Learning Trust, was praised for pupils' confidence, extracurricular clubs, leadership and above-average attendance. ([The Star](#))
- **Sheffield has signed up to a near-90-council scheme to tackle NEET numbers.** The move brings councils, schools, colleges, employers and health services together after figures showed one of England's higher NEET rates among 16-17 year-olds locally. ([The Star](#))
→ **For your school:** Worth a word with your careers lead about how the scheme touches post-16 transition tracking.

FROM THE CORRIDOR

Scope for negotiation is exhausted.

Pepe Di'Iasio, ASCL general secretary, on Ofsted

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

■ SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment

Source	Type	What we track
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.